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Hello Future of Life Institute team,

Thank you for the opportunity. I have spent the last few years building AI tools for real businesses, and the ones that earned their place were narrow and supervised by a person. That is the controllable, human-directed path your posting describes. Making that case from the industry side is where I think I can add most value.

The clearest example is a production MCP server I built on the Claude API. It gives a model eight scoped tools, checks every write against the last known version and logs every session, so the person using it can see everything it has done.

It is a small example. It is also the shape of most of what I saw create value for the 20+ technology founders I advised at Ziplake - AI that does one job reliably for someone who stays in charge.

Reliability as a hard requirement is where I started. At Nine Network I was the sole designer of the broadcaster's digital presence for the Beijing 2008 Olympics, and covered on-call for 24/7 live output, where 100% is the minimum. Later I sold into Roche Diagnostics and the NHS, regulated buyers who need reliability proven before anything goes live.

In terms of building coalitions - the Roche agreement was between a 15-person startup and an $80B business, and it stalled inside Legal and Compliance.

Unsticking it meant working both organisations at once. Keeping Roche's commercial sponsors visible so the process carried business pressure, whilst moving our own founder to concede on policy and hold firm on exclusivity and the minimum commitment. It ended up being signed, and that channel went on to produce NHS sales and a ten-year contract with OLVG - a very large hospital group in Amsterdam.

A lot of my career has been translating between engineers and buyers. I went from Senior Solutions Engineer to Technical Director to VP at Brightcove, leading Asia from ~$4M to ~$11.5M ARR across 15+ countries.

To be clear on the gap - I have not worked in policy or briefed a ministry. The audience is new to me, however landing a technical argument with senior people who are not engineers is not.

I am based in Valencia on CET, and happy to travel to Brussels and for the team meetups.

Happy to hop on a call to talk through any of the above.

Thanks for your time and your consideration,
Ben Morrell